

Self-Descriptive Survey: Variable Codebook

Department of Psychology

February 13, 2026

Table of contents

1 Overview	1
2 Demographic Variables	1
3 Psychological Scale Variables	3
4 Variable Quick Reference	4

1 Overview

This codebook describes 35 variables collected from 547 undergraduate participants in the Self-Descriptive Survey. Variables are organized into two sections: demographic/background items and psychological scale scores. Missing values are coded as **-99** throughout the dataset.

2 Demographic Variables

The following 19 items capture participant background and life circumstances.

Table 1: Demographic and background variables

Item	Demographic Variable	Value Labels
1	What is your age? (age)	years
2	How do you currently describe your gender identity? (gender)	Male (1); Female (2); Another (3)
3	What is your sexual orientation and/or sexual identity? (sexorient)	Asexual (1); Bisexual (2); Demisexual (3); Gay (4); Lesbian (5); Pansexual (6); Queer (7); Questioning (8); Sexually fluid (9); Straight or heterosexual (10); Other (11)
4	When thinking about physical attributes usually ascribed to race, which of the following general labels describe how you would describe yourself racially? (race)	Asian (1); Black (2); Indigenous, Aboriginal, or First Nations (3); Latino or Hispanic (4); Middle Eastern (5); White (6); Other (7)
5	What hand do you use to write with? (hand)	Right (1); Left (2); Both (3)
6	How is the area where you spent the majority of your childhood best described? (community)	Rural (1); Small town (2); Suburban (3); Urban (4)
7	Did one or more of your parents graduate from a four-year college? (parentedu)	No (0); Yes (1)
8	Thinking about your childhood, which social class did you identify with? (famclass)	Working class (1); Lower class (2); Lower middle class (3); Upper middle class (4); Upper class (5)
9	What was your families' income during your senior year in high school? (faminc)	USD
10	How many siblings do you have? (numsib)	number of siblings
11	How many times did you move as a child? (move)	number of moves
12	How many people do you think of as your close friends? (clsfrn)	number of close friends
13	How many people do you think would list you as a close friend of theirs? (clsfist)	number of close friends
14	Are you a member of a fraternity or sorority? (greek_in)	Independent (1); Greek (2)
15	Are you living on campus during the current semester? (campus)	No (0); Yes (1)
16	Are you currently (romantic relationship status)? (relsp)	In a monogamous relationship (1); In a polyamorous relationship (multiple relationships with the consent of participants) (2); In multiple relationships (without those involved knowing about each other) (3); Not in a relationship (4); I prefer not to answer (5)
17	How long was your current or most recent romantic relationship? (rlength)	months
18	Please rate the seriousness of your current or most recent romantic relationship. (serious)	0-7
19	How many different romantic relationships have you been in during your lifetime? (numrels)	number of relationships

3 Psychological Scale Variables

The dataset includes scores from 6 psychological instruments.

Item 20–23: Automatic Thoughts Questionnaire (ATQ-30) (ATQ)

Negative Self-Concepts & Negative Expectations subscale (ATQ); Personal Maladjustment & Desire for Change subscale (ATQ); Low Self-Esteem subscale (ATQ); Helplessness subscale (ATQ) subscales (higher scores indicate greater negative automatic thoughts (nats))

Provides a quantitative measure of the cognitive component of depressive disorders, focusing on the frequency of spontaneous negative self-referential cognitions.

Reference: Hollon & Kendall (1980)

Item 24: New General Self-Efficacy Scale (NGSE)

Single scale score (higher scores indicate greater generalized self-efficacy)

Measures generalized self-efficacy and an individual's belief in their overall competence to perform across a variety of achievement situations.

Reference: Chen, Gully, & Eden (2001)

Item 25: Core Self-Evaluations Scale (CSES)

Single scale score (higher scores indicate greater core self-evaluations (self-worth, effectiveness, capability))

A direct measure of core self-evaluations, a broad latent higher-order personality trait indicated by self-esteem, generalized self-efficacy, neuroticism (reversed), and locus of control. Predicts job satisfaction, job performance, and life satisfaction.

Reference: Judge, Erez, Bono, & Thoresen (2003)

Item 26–29: Multidimensional Attitude towards Ambiguity Scale (MAAS)

Discomfort with Ambiguity subscale (MAAS); Moral Absolutism/Splitting subscale (MAAS); Need for Complexity and Novelty subscale (MAAS) subscales (higher scores indicate greater attitudes toward ambiguity)

Measures attitudes toward ambiguity across multiple dimensions including discomfort with ambiguity, moral absolutism/splitting, and need for complexity.

Reference: McLain et al. (2015)

Item 30: Need-for-Arousal Questionnaire (NFA)

Single scale score (higher scores indicate greater need for arousal)

Measures an individual's dispositional need for arousal, excitement, and stimulation versus preference for predictability and routine.

Reference: Figner, Mackinlay, Wilkening, & Weber (2009)

Item 31–35: Ten-Item Personality Inventory (TIPI) (TIPI)

Extraversion subscale (TIPI); Agreeableness subscale (TIPI); Conscientiousness subscale (TIPI); Emotional Stability subscale (TIPI); Openness to Experience subscale (TIPI) subscales (higher scores indicate greater big five personality dimensions)

A very brief measure of the Big Five personality domains. Developed for situations where time is limited, personality is not the primary topic, or researchers can tolerate somewhat diminished psychometric properties.

Reference: Gosling, Rentfrow, & Swann (2003)

4 Variable Quick Reference

Table 2: All scale and subscale variables in the dataset

Scale	Variable	Label	Scoring
ATQ	nsne	Negative Self-Concepts & Negative Expectations subscale (ATQ)	Average of 6-items: 2, 3, 9, 21, 23, 24. Higher scores indicate more frequent negative automatic thoughts.
ATQ	pmdc	Personal Maladjustment & Desire for Change subscale (ATQ)	Average of 5-items: 7, 10, 14, 20, 26. Higher scores indicate more frequent maladjustment.
ATQ	lse	Low Self-Esteem subscale (ATQ)	Average of 2-items: 17, 18. Higher scores indicate more frequent low self-esteem automatic thoughts.
ATQ	help	Helplessness subscale (ATQ)	Average of 2-items: 29, 30. Higher scores indicate more frequent negative helpless automatic thoughts.
NGSE	ngse	New general self-efficacy scale	Average all 8 items. Higher scores indicate greater generalized self-efficacy.
CSES	cses	Core self-evaluations scale	Reverse-score items 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, then average all 12 items. Higher scores indicate more positive core self-evaluations. This measure is nonproprietary and free to use.
MAAS	maas	Multidimensional Attitude towards Ambiguity Scale (MAAS) total	Score subscales separately by averaging the items in each subscale.
MAAS	disc	Discomfort with Ambiguity subscale (MAAS)	Average of 7-items: 53, 76, 75, 71, 54, 57, 86 (original numbering). Higher scores indicate greater discomfort with ambiguity.
MAAS	moral	Moral Absolutism/Splitting subscale (MAAS)	Average of 7-items: 29, 28, 27, 24, 123, 25, 34 (original numbering). Higher scores indicate greater moral absolutism.
MAAS	comp	Need for Complexity and Novelty subscale (MAAS)	Average of 7-items: 19, 4, 17, 90, 112, 93, 12 (original numbering). Higher scores indicate greater attraction to complexity.
NFA	nfa	Need for Arousal scale	Reverse-score items 2, 3, 6, 8, then average of 8 items. Higher scores indicate greater need for arousal.
TIPI	extraversion	Extraversion subscale (TIPI)	Average items 1 and 6R (reverse-scored). Higher scores indicate more extraversion.
TIPI	agreeableness	Agreeableness subscale (TIPI)	Average items 2R (reverse-scored) and 7. Higher scores indicate more agreeableness.
TIPI	conscientiousness	Conscientiousness subscale (TIPI)	Average items 3 and 8R (reverse-scored). Higher scores indicate more conscientiousness.
TIPI	emot_stability	Emotional Stability subscale (TIPI)	Average items 4R (reverse-scored) and 9. Higher scores indicate more emotional stability.
TIPI	openness	Openness to Experience subscale (TIPI)	Average items 5 and 10R (reverse-scored). Higher scores indicate more openness.